

HARRIET VANDELEUR

Solicitor of England and Wales - Corporate and Commercial - 5 years PQE

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PROFILE

Commercial solicitor admitted in September 2021, five years' post-qualification experience gained in the corporate and commercial teams of two national firms. Practice split roughly 60/40 between private M&A on deals of 3m to 45m enterprise value and standalone commercial contracting, with a growing data protection advisory practice. Regularly run mid-market transactions with limited supervision, including two disclosure exercises taken from first draft to signing without a partner amendment. Looking for a move into a team where the corporate work is the main event rather than an adjunct to real estate.

QUALIFICATIONS AND ADMISSION

Admitted as a solicitor, England and Wales

September 2021

Legal Practice Course with MSc in Law, Business and Management, Ravensmoor College of Law, Birmingham

2017 - 2018, Distinction

Graduate Diploma in Law, Ravensmoor College of Law

2016 - 2017, Commendation

BA (Hons) History, Kesterwick University

2013 - 2016, 2:1

EXPERIENCE

Wraysbury Hale LLP, Birmingham

Associate, Corporate and Commercial

Associate (2 PQE on joining) - March 2023 to present

- Run share and asset purchases in the 3m to 45m EV range, typically four to six live matters, acting for both buy-side and sell-side. Responsible for the transaction timetable, the disclosure exercise, ancillary documents and completion mechanics.
- Led the disclosure exercise on the sale of a 38m turnover facilities management business, including a data room of 2,100 documents and a disclosure letter settled across nine drafts.
- Draft and negotiate commercial agreements: supply and distribution, master services agreements, SaaS terms, reseller and agency arrangements, NDAs at volume.
- Advise on UK GDPR compliance for a retail client group - controller and processor mapping, a suite of DPAs and international transfer risk assessments following the 2021 SCCs.
- Supervise two trainees per seat and mark their drafting. Run the team's monthly know-how session on warranty and indemnity drafting.
- Contribute to the firm's corporate precedent bank; rewrote the management warranty schedule now used as the team standard.

Dunmore Kerridge LLP, Nottingham

Solicitor, Corporate

Sept 2021 - Feb 2023 (NQ to 1.5 PQE)

- Newly qualified into corporate on a team of eleven. Ran the smaller end of the deal list independently from about six months in.
- Company secretarial and group reorganisation work: share buybacks, reductions of capital, articles amendments, EMI option scheme implementation for three technology clients.

- Drafted the ancillary suite on eleven completed transactions and co-ordinated four completions where the client was in a different time zone.
- Seconded for three months to the in-house legal team of a logistics client, handling day-to-day contracting and one supplier dispute that settled before proceedings were issued.

SELECTED MATTERS

Client names are anonymised in accordance with professional obligations. All matters below were led or substantially run by me.

1. Acted for the founders on the 45m sale of a specialist recruitment group to a listed acquirer. Ran the disclosure exercise, the W&I insurance process alongside brokers, and the earn-out drafting covering a three-year period.
2. Acted for a private equity-backed trade buyer on the 12.5m acquisition of a competitor out of an accelerated sale process, completed on a nine-day timetable with locked-box consideration.
3. Advised a family-owned manufacturer on a 6m minority investment, including the investment agreement, amended articles and a shareholders' deadlock mechanism that survived two subsequent disputes.
4. Ran a group reorganisation for a construction client ahead of a planned exit: four intra-group transfers, a capital reduction demerger and the associated HMRC clearances.
5. Negotiated a five-year master services agreement and eleven statements of work for a technology client with an annual contract value of 2.8m, including a liability cap position that became the client's standard.
6. Advised a retail group on UK GDPR remediation following a supplier breach affecting approximately 40,000 customer records - containment advice, ICO notification assessment and the resulting DPA rewrite.
7. Acted on the 3.2m acquisition of a veterinary practice group, including the RCVS regulatory consents and TUPE consultation timetable.
8. Drafted and negotiated a distribution agreement for entry into three EU markets, co-ordinating local counsel in Germany, Poland and the Netherlands on competition law compliance.
9. Defended a warranty claim brought eighteen months after completion; advised on the notice provisions and secured discontinuance without payment.
10. Advised on an EMI option scheme and its accelerated vesting on a subsequent share sale, including the HMRC valuation agreement.

TRAINING CONTRACT

Dunmore Kerridge LLP - September 2019 to September 2021

Seat 1: Corporate (Sep 2019 - Mar 2020)

Due diligence, ancillary drafting, Companies House filings. Sat through two completions.

Seat 2: Commercial Property (Mar 2020 - Sep 2020)

Largely remote. Leases, licences to alter, and a portfolio refinance requiring 41 certificates of title.

Seat 3: Employment (Sept 2020 - March 2021)

Settlement agreements at volume during the redundancy wave, two tribunal bundles, TUPE advice on a services transfer.

Seat 4: Commercial and IP (03/2021 - 09/2021)

Supply contracts, a trade mark opposition, and the firm's first standalone AI procurement contract.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Fenchurch Mallory Solicitors - Paralegal, Commercial Litigation

July 2018 to August 2019

- Disclosure review on a 14m contractual dispute; managed a review team of four paralegals and the Relativity workspace.
- Drafted witness statement first drafts and chronologies.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND MEMBERSHIPS

- Member, Law Society of England and Wales
- Member, Birmingham Trainee Solicitors' Society (committee 2020-21)
- IAPP CIPP/E - Certified Information Privacy Professional, Europe (2024)
- Advanced Negotiation for Corporate Lawyers, two-day course (Nov 2024)
- Co-author, 'Warranty limitations after the 2023 cases', firm client briefing, issued February 2025

ADDITIONAL

Pro bono: fortnightly volunteer adviser at a Birmingham law centre since 2022, principally consumer and housing enquiries. Trustee of a small local arts charity (appointed 2024) with responsibility for its contracts and data protection compliance. Conversational French. Full clean UK driving licence. Available at one month's notice.

REFERENCES

Available on request. Please do not approach my current firm without prior consent.